

TRADE NOTES / ORIGIN ROULETTE

Shrimp sourcing stopped being a price spreadsheet.

For 2026 books, the winning origin is the one that clears tariff gates, certification depth, disease windows, and landed-cost risk.

WHAT BROKE

Three desk assumptions failed in fifteen months.

The U.S. would take every kilo.

Ecuador's cost edge would narrow.

Value-added processing was a side quest.

NEW BUYER QUESTION

It is no longer: is there enough shrimp?

It is: which shrimp clears the regulatory gate, keeps the landed-cost curve sane, and does not trap the book inside one origin's policy risk?

RISK > VOLUME

ORIGIN MAP

Each origin now has a job.

ECUADOR

raw HLSO cost anchor

INDIA

cooked + EU value-add swing

VIETNAM

processing depth,
documentation clock

INDONESIA

small U.S. diversifier if certs
hold

THAILAND

premium cooked, labour
scrutiny

CHINA

demand-side price floor

DECISION RULE

Q3 spot and Q1 forward are different games.

Q3 2026 SPOT

Tariffs and landed cost dominate. Ecuador and India carry the book; Indonesia is a certified tranche.

Q1 2027 FORWARD

Regulatory trajectory dominates. Residue control, approvals, SIMP, forced-labour issues, and CATCH decide durability.

ASYMMETRIC BETS

The better move is not always the cheapest kilo.

India cooked 21/25 for EU retail can beat Ecuadorian HLSO on margin.

Indonesia can be convex U.S. cover if certification keeps holding.

30-count vs 60-count can flip India vs Ecuador economics.

OPERATOR PROBLEM

This cannot live in one spreadsheet anymore.

Origin strategy now touches supplier emails, ERP items, tariff memos, QA files, certification dates, WhatsApp exceptions, and customer commitments.

THE BOOK IS A WORKFLOW

UBIK

We are building the operator layer for this kind of trade work.

Above CRM, ERP, email, WhatsApp, documents, and approvals. Human-reviewed agent workflows for perishable trade teams.